

Opinion of the Court

If the President claims authority to act but in fact exercises mere “individual will” and “authority without law,” the courts may say so. *Youngstown*, 343 U.S., at 655 (Jackson, J., concurring). In *Youngstown*, for instance, we held that President Truman exceeded his constitutional authority when he seized most of the Nation’s steel mills. See *id.*, at 582–589 (majority opinion). But once it is determined that the President acted within the scope of his exclusive authority, his discretion in exercising such authority cannot be subject to further judicial examination.

The Constitution, for example, vests the “Power to Grant Reprieves and Pardons for Offences against the United States” in the President. Art. II, §2, cl. 1. During and after the Civil War, President Lincoln, and later President Johnson, offered a full pardon, with restoration of property rights, to anyone who had “engaged in the rebellion” but agreed to take an oath of allegiance to the Union. *United States v. Klein*, 13 Wall. 128, 139–141 (1872). But in 1870, Congress enacted a provision that prohibited using the President’s pardon as evidence of restoration of property rights. *Id.*, at 143–144. Chief Justice Chase held the provision unconstitutional because it “impair[ed] the effect of a pardon, and thus infring[ed] the constitutional power of the Executive.” *Id.*, at 147. “To the executive alone is intrusted the power of pardon,” and the “legislature cannot change the effect of such a pardon any more than the executive can change a law.” *Id.*, at 147–148. The President’s authority to pardon, in other words, is “conclusive and preclusive,” “disabling the Congress from acting upon the subject.” *Youngstown*, 343 U.S., at 637–638 (Jackson, J., concurring).

Some of the President’s other constitutional powers also fit that description. “The President’s power to remove—and thus supervise—those who wield executive power on his behalf,” for instance, “follows from the text of Article II.” *Seila Law LLC v. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau*, 591 U.S. 197, 204 (2020). We have thus held that Congress